THE CINCINNATI (OH) CHAPTER OF
THE LINKS, INCORPORATED
PRESENTS

ESSENCE *of* EMERALDS

A Night of Legacy & Light: 7 Decades

SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 7, 2026

5:00 – 9:00 PM

FIRST FINANCIAL CONVENTION CENTER

BLACK TIE

PLACEHOLDER — COVER: the chapter's newest cover artwork drops in here when received

SCROLL TO OPEN THE PROGRAM ↓

INSIDE THE PROGRAM

Contents

I Welcome

II Greetings — Shuana Tucker-Sims, Ph.D., National President

III Greetings — Sheila R. Brown, Central Area Director

IV Greetings — Mayor Aftab Pureval, City of Cincinnati

V The Evening

VI Keynote Speaker — Susan L. Taylor

VII Emcee — Kyle Inskeep

VIII A Legacy of Service

IX Chapter Leadership

X Our Presidents, 1950 – Today

XI Chapter Members

XII Essence of Emeralds Co-Chairs

XIII Honorary Co-Chairs

XIV Our Sponsors

XV Program Ads

XVI Links Leadership Academy for Girls

Welcome

Patrice Baughman Borders, President

PLACEHOLDER — SAMPLE WELCOME: to be replaced by President Borders' greeting letter in the final program

Dear friends, on behalf of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter of The Links, Incorporated, it is my joy to welcome you to Essence of Emeralds — A Night of Legacy & Light. Tonight we celebrate seventy years of friendship and service in the Queen City, and we are so glad you are here.

Over 75 years ago, a circle of Cincinnati women organized this chapter around a simple conviction: that friendship, put to work in service, can change a community. Generation after generation, the women of this chapter have kept that promise — mentoring our daughters, championing the arts, advancing health and education, and standing wherever Cincinnati has needed us most.

Tonight belongs to everyone who has carried that promise forward: our charter members and past presidents, our alumnae, our sponsors and partners, and the remarkable young women of the Links Leadership Academy for Girls, whose future is the truest measure of our legacy. We are honored to welcome our keynote speaker, Susan L. Taylor, whose life's work — lifting up our children and our community — so beautifully mirrors our own.

Thank you for your presence, your generosity, and your light. Enjoy the evening.

In friendship and service,
Patrice Baughman Borders

Patrice Baughman Borders, President
Cincinnati (OH) Chapter, The Links, Incorporated

National President

NATIONAL PRESIDENT · THE LINKS, INCORPORATED

Shuana Tucker-Sims, Ph.D.

The Cincinnati (OH) Chapter is honored to receive a greeting from our National President as we celebrate seven decades of friendship and service.

PLACEHOLDER — GREETING TO COME: Dr. Tucker-Sims's greeting letter and final portrait are forthcoming

Shuana Tucker-Sims, Ph.D., National President
The Links, Incorporated

Central Area Director

CENTRAL AREA DIRECTOR · THE LINKS, INCORPORATED

Sheila R. Brown

The Cincinnati (OH) Chapter is honored to receive a greeting from our Central Area Director as we celebrate seven decades of friendship and service.

PLACEHOLDER — GREETING TO COME: Director Brown's greeting letter and final portrait are forthcoming

Sheila R. Brown, Central Area Director
Central Area, The Links, Incorporated

Mayor of Cincinnati

MAYOR · CITY OF CINCINNATI, OHIO

Aftab Pureval

The Cincinnati (OH) Chapter is honored to receive a greeting from the Mayor of Cincinnati as we celebrate seven decades of friendship and service.

PLACEHOLDER — GREETING TO COME: Mayor Pureval's greeting letter and final portrait are forthcoming

Aftab Pureval, Mayor
City of Cincinnati, Ohio

The Evening

5:00 PM — VIP Reception

The evening opens with a VIP reception for sponsors, patrons, and special guests.

6:00 PM — Dinner & Program

A seated dinner and the evening's program, celebrating seven decades of friendship and service.

Keynote — Susan L. Taylor

Keynote address by Susan L. Taylor, former Editor in Chief of Essence Magazine and founder of the National CARES Mentoring Movement.

Live Music — 2nd Wind Band

Live music from the 2nd Wind Band carries the celebration through the night.

Susan L. Taylor

Susan L. Taylor is the founder and CEO of the National CARES Mentoring Movement, a best-selling author of four books and editor of eight others, a fourth-generation entrepreneur, and the former editor-in-chief of Essence magazine.

She joined Essence in 1970 and became editor-in-chief in 1981, later serving as editorial director and shaping Essence into a world-renowned brand with more than 8 million readers.

In 2006 she founded the National CARES Mentoring Movement as Essence CARES. With local affiliates in 58 cities, National CARES has recruited, trained, and deployed more than 250,000 mentors to schools and youth-support and mentoring organizations like Big Brothers, Big Sisters, as well as to its own culturally rooted, academic- and social-transformational initiatives.

She is the recipient of more than a dozen honorary doctorates and hundreds of awards, including the NAACP President's Award and the Henry Johnson Fisher Award from the Magazine Publishers Association, and she was the first African American woman inducted into the American Society of Magazine Editors Hall of Fame.

Kyle Inskeep

Anchor, Local 12

Kyle Inskeep joined the Local 12 news team in June 2018 and anchors the station's 5 p.m., 5:30 p.m., 6 p.m. and 11 p.m. newscasts.

Prior to Cincinnati, he was a morning reporter and fill-in anchor for FOX59 in Indianapolis. He began his career at NBC News in Washington, D.C. as the Tim Russert Fellow.

Recently, Kyle was appointed to the board of directors for the Cincinnati Symphony Orchestra and the Landmark Columbus Foundation.

Linked in Friendship and Connected in Service.

A Legacy of Service

The story of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter of The Links, Incorporated

On March 30, 1950, a distinguished group of women answered the call to service and founded the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter.

Founding and Heritage

The chapter was chartered on March 30, 1950, by twelve visionary women: Ethel M. Taylor, Alberta E. Hanksin, Anna V. Merritt, Thema Donelson, Josephine Y. Ward, Marian Strader, Lutie Lewis, Ora Glidewell, Lottie J. Harris, Margaret Richardson, Theresa Dowell and Lucille Ridley Williams.

As the 17th chapter of The Links, Incorporated, Cincinnati (OH) has carried forward a steadfast legacy of friendship, service and excellence for more than seven decades.

Leadership and Cultural Contributions

Our chapter has been led by women who have shaped both the community and the organization. Vada W. Martin served as National President (1974–1976). Barbara J. Smith followed as National President (1980–1982) and International President (1982–1984). Link Verda R. Hazen was elected National President (2004–2006).

Cincinnati (OH) Links have enriched the cultural landscape through the arts — sponsoring concerts, festivals and collaborations that inspire and uplift.

Philanthropy and Community Impact

Our commitment to service is both historic and far reaching. The chapter established Camp Joy for children fighting cancer. We hosted the Ebony Fashion Fair, raising more than $1,000,000 for scholarships and community programs.

We have awarded countless scholarships and grants, partnering with organizations across the Greater Cincinnati area. Our global impact includes building the first Links School in Africa.

Signature Programs and Initiatives

Over the decades, our signature programs have empowered generations and addressed critical needs: College Jamboree, Discovery '70, Focus: '88 — The Black Artists, Young Achievers and the Youth Docent Program.

The Links Leadership Academy for Girls

In 2019, the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter founded The Links Leadership Academy for Girls to nurture leadership in the next generation. See Page Sixteen for the full story.

Linked in Friendship and Connected in Service.

Chapter Leadership

The officers of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter, from the chapter's 2025–2026 Greenbook directory

PRESIDENT

Patrice Baughman Borders

VICE PRESIDENT

Linda F. Rudolph

RECORDING SECRETARY

Tonie Britton

CORRESPONDING SECRETARY

Brandy Jones

TREASURER

Jennifer Allen

FINANCIAL SECRETARY

Monica Newby

ASSISTANT FINANCIAL SECRETARY

Tiffany Dunn

PARLIAMENTARIAN

Ariana Nami Harris

Our Presidents

The women who have led the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter since its chartering in 1950

Margaret Clarke	1950–1952
Johnnie Mae Berry	1952–1954
Mary Weatherly	1954–1956
Vivian Beamon	1956–1960
Virginia Coffey	1960–1962
Constance Stone	1962–1964
Bernice Henry	1964–1966
Reber Cann	1966–1968
Laura Lovelace	1968–1972
Marian Spencer	1972–1976
Lois Conyers	1976–1978
Virginia Coffey	1978–1981
Lucille Conliffe	1981–1983
Adoria Whittaker	1983–1985

Yvonne Roberts	1985–1989
Charlotte James	1989–1993
Gwendolyn Wilder	1993–1997
Deborah Spradley	1997–2001
Theresa Henderson	2001–2005
Adrienne James	2005–2007
Kathy Wade	2007
Janet Reid	2007–2009
Kristi Clement Williams	2009–2013
Winona McNeil	2013–2017
Shelley Jefferson Hamler	2017–2021
Bleuzette Marshall	2021–2025
Patrice Baughman Borders	2025–Present

Signature Programs

LLAG Career Conference — Each year, the LLAG Career Conference serves nearly 100 girls, providing mentorship, guidance, and real-world exposure.

Black K.A.R.E. Program — The Black K.A.R.E. program empowers and uplifts communities through service and outreach.

Chapter Members

The members of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter, from the chapter's current 2026 roster

Jennifer Marie Allen

Tracey Ann Artis

Cynthia O. Booth

Patrice Baughman Borders

Lauren Braddock Moffett

Tonie Britton

Lesli Irene Brower

Doris Clement Burton ★

Stephanie Evelyn Wright Byrd

Regina Carswell Russo

Kristi Clement Williams

Takiyah Cunningham

Grace McCaster Daniels

Nicole Leslie Dowdell

Tiffany Dunn

Agnes Godwin-Hall

Shelley Jefferson Hamler

Renee Mahaffey Harris

Stacey Louise Shells Harvey

Tiana A. Henry

Renetta Ethridge Holloway

Sherry Hughes

Brandy L. Jones

Camille Arnel Jones

Jan-Michele Lemon Kearney

Lisa D. Kelly

Helen Kemp

Edna Keown

Elodie Killins

Taren Kinebrew

Rasheda Malcolm-Cromwell	Lizzie Ngwenya-Scoburgh
Bleuzette Marshall	Janet Butler Reid
Winona McNeil ★	Linda F. Rudolph
Megan McNeil-Wallace	Shelly S. Sherman
Debra S. Merchant	Wanda Wall Spivey
Mary Woode Morton	Kathy Wade-Jenkins
Janet Bell Myles	Nita Walker
Ariana Nami Harris	Deborah A. White Richardson
Monica L. Newby	Gwendolyn West Wilder ★

Platinum Members

A silver star beside a name identifies a Platinum member.

Doris Clement Burton ★ · Winona McNeil ★ · Gwendolyn West Wilder ★

Essence of Emeralds Co-Chairs

The women behind tonight's celebration

GALA CO-CHAIR

Tonie Britton

GALA CO-CHAIR

Tracey Artis

PLACEHOLDER — fundraising subcommittee chairs to be added when the chapter sends the names

Honorary Co-Chairs

All three of our Honorary Co-Chairs are Platinum members of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter

HONORARY CO-CHAIR

Gwen Wilder ★

HONORARY CO-CHAIR

Doris Clement Burton ★

HONORARY CO-CHAIR

Winona McNeil ★

Our Sponsors

Essence of Emeralds is made possible by the generosity of our partners and friends

Presenting Partner — $10,000

Fifth Third Bank

Community Partner — $5,000

Bi3 · METRO · Mount St. Joseph · First Financial Bank · Tri-Health · Visit Cincy · Messer

Impact Partner — $3,000 – $2,500

3CDC ($3,000) · The Haile Foundation ($2,500) · The Center for Closing The Health Gap ($2,500) · Union Savings Bank ($2,500) · Janet B. Reid, Ph.D. ($2,500) · NCBMP (National Coalition of Black Meeting Planners) ($2,500) · Megen Construction ($2,500) · Duke Energy ($2,500) · TRIVERSITY ($2,500)

Mission Partner — Below $2,500

Miles Of Change Foundation ($1,500) · PNC ($1,500) · Dinsmore & Shohl LLP ($1,200) · Gilman Partners ($1,000) · Owens Foundation ($1,000) · Truist ($1,000) · Steve Schwartz ($1,000) · Interact for Health ($1,000) · The Cochran Firm ($1,000) · Acts 1:8 Services ($1,000) · Jack P. Arkle Financial Services ($500) · Charles Schwab ($500) · Jack & Jill of America, Cincinnati Chapter ($100)

Program Ads

Congratulations, tributes, and community ads submitted through the Digital Ad Upload form

PLACEHOLDER — AD ARTWORK: the ads below are listed in program order; each ad's artwork drops in full-width, exactly as received (the chapter is still taking ads until Monday)

Mayor Tonya Key, Village of Lincoln Heights — congratulating the Queen City Links

Archway (MO) Chapter — group portrait

Queen City (OH) Chapter — congratulating Cincinnati on 7 Decades of friendship and service

Dentistry Details — April Hearns, D.D.S., general dentist, West Chester, Ohio

Mayor Ron Washington, City of Covington, Kentucky — greetings

Reston (VA) Chapter — congratulating on 70 years of friendship, service and impact

Columbus (OH) Chapter — congratulating Cincinnati on its 70th

Tribute in loving memory of Lucille H. Conliffe, Platinum Link and Cincinnati Chapter president 1981–1983

RestoreMD — Dr. Eakins, medical director, health, wellness and aesthetics

Honoring the Cincinnati Chapter's 2008 inductees, in loving memory of Tysha Wilder

Author Dr. Ricky Sherrer and his books — Just a Voice Ministries

Twin Rivers (OH) Chapter — saluting Essence of Emeralds

Wichita (KS) Chapter — celebrating seven decades of friendship and service

Headshot photograph submitted by Patrice Borders

Dayton (OH) Chapter — wishing Cincinnati a Happy 70th Anniversary

Cincinnati Opera — world premiere of "John Lewis: Good Trouble" at Music Hall

"The Beat Goes On" — heart and cross with heartbeat line

Cincinnati Cancer Advisors — "a second opinion can change what comes next"

Friars Club — blue and gold circular seal, established 1860

Cincinnati Chapter of Top Ladies of Distinction, Inc. — congratulations

Quad Cities (IL) Chapter — celebrating 70th Anniversary: seven decades of friendship, service, sisterhood and impact

Choosi MedSpa — congratulating The Links on over 70 years of friendship and service; physician led by Tiffany Hall, MD

Zest for Living — 10-week Self-Leadership Journey, Sandra R. Hughes

Lincoln Heights Outreach Inc. — "Providing opportunities. Enriching lives."

reCappin' with Delora & Ashley — pop culture podcast, new episodes Tuesdays and Thursdays

Women's Alliance — celebrating 60 years of scholarship, service, and sisterhood

DLuxe Transportation — "Arrive in Luxury"

Balloons Your Way — balloon decor in pink, gold and blue

Bryan & Sylvia Nelson — The Nelson Team, Comey & Shepherd Realtors

Archway (MO) Chapter — celebrating seven decades of friendship and service

Tulsa (OK) Chapter — congratulating the Link Sisters of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter

Triversity Construction — congratulating The Links on 70 Years of Service

Newby Orthodontics — Monica L. Newby, DDS, orthodontics for children, adolescents and adults

Forward Fitness Training

Links Leadership Academy for Girls

Where Cincinnati's daughters become Cincinnati's leaders

What It Is

The Links Leadership Academy for Girls (LLAG) is a signature, high-impact leadership development program for African American high school girls.

What Makes LLAG Special

- Designed exclusively to uplift and empower African American girls
- Led by accomplished professional women dedicated to mentorship and service
- Focuses on identity, leadership voice, and confidence — not just academics
- Connects participants to real-world civic, cultural, and professional experiences
- Builds a lasting sisterhood rooted in accountability, belonging, and support

9 – 12 GRADES SERVED	2019 ACADEMY FOUNDED
1 of 3 NATIONAL HOST SITES, 2021	Nearly 100 GIRLS AT EACH CAREER CONFERENCE

Who It's For

LLAG is designed for African American girls in grades 9–12 who are ready to lead, grow, and thrive.

Impact & Outcomes

LLAG empowers participants to become confident leaders with increased self-confidence, stronger communication skills, a clearer sense of purpose, and access to higher education and career pathways. Graduates go on to lead with excellence in their schools, communities, and beyond.

Why It's Needed

African American girls face systemic barriers, including underrepresentation and limited access to leadership development. LLAG bridges that gap — creating pathways to power, purpose, and possibility.

Mission & Vision

The Links Leadership Academy for Girls equips African American high school girls with the leadership skills, mentorship, and transformative experiences they need to recognize their power, pursue their purpose, and thrive locally, nationally, and globally.

LLAG is a signature program of the Cincinnati (OH) Chapter of The Links, Incorporated.

THANK YOU

Thank You

The Cincinnati (OH) Chapter of The Links, Incorporated thanks our sponsors, patrons, community partners, and every guest who shared this night of legacy and light with us.

Learn more about the chapter and its programs at **cincinnatilinks.org**.

Event details: Essence of Emeralds — A Night of Legacy & Light: 7 Decades, Saturday, November 7, 2026, First Financial Convention Center, Cincinnati.

The welcome letter on Page One is placeholder sample content, to be replaced with the President's greeting letter in the final program. The greeting pages on Pages Two through Four are likewise held for the final program: greeting letters and final portraits from the National President, the Central Area Director, and the Mayor of Cincinnati are forthcoming. The Program Ads are the actual artwork files submitted through the Digital Ad Upload form, included exactly as received.